

Company: UBS (Union Bank of Switzerland)

Job Profile: Graduate Trainee

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 60k/month

CTC: 14.5 LPA (12.5L fixed + 2L variable)

Location: Pune/Hyderabad

Process Date: Pre Placement Talk(PPT) + Online Assessment(OA): 10th July 2025

Interviews: 14th July 2025

Placement Process:

All candidates who had applied were to give a **UBS culture test (not timed)** and **Aptitude test (2 rounds 6 minutes speed based pattern recognition + 6 minutes 18 questions paragraph based)**. This test was to be given from home by applying on UBS website.

Some failed to give this test and were not shortlisted for OA.

1. Online Assessment [173 candidates appeared]

Platform: HackerRank (**Oncampus**) Time Limit: **90 minutes**

Format: 15 Aptitude + 15 OOPS/Java/SQL/DSA + 1 Coding Question

Section 1: 15 Aptitude questions were pretty much doable based on sets, probability, statistics, and some could be just answered by looking at the given graph (It was initially not very visible, just pull the image then it'll be clearly visible).

Section 2: 15 OOPS/Java/SQL/DSA were very basic if you have fundamental knowledge. The OOPS questions were in Java but even if you are from C++/Python background then knowledge of OOPS would help you clear it. SQL was simple syntactical as well. Some questions were also MCQ based on DSA like inorder of a given tree.

Section 3: The coding question was a bit tricky to understand. I can't clearly remember it but it was to be done by using TreeSet / PriorityQueue in Java.

I tried the coding question first for about 20 minutes but was able to pass just 1 test case then my platform was stuck for about 10 minutes so I quickly informed the invigilator. After the problem was solved (I didn't get my time back) I proceeded to section 2 and did that quickly and then completed section 1. Then I went on to the coding question which then I tried using PriorityQueue till the end of the time it passed 9 test cases and the assessment was finally over.

6 of the candidates were part of UBS Hackathon who had appeared for an OA in March 2025 so they were directly shortlisted for interviews, so **14 candidates (including me) were shortlisted from July 2025 OA** (A rather low number of candidates).

2. Technical Round [20 candidates appeared]

The round started by the interviewer going through my resume in the meantime asking me to introduce myself. Then he asked me to tell me my favorite project among the projects in my resume. I was told to draw the architecture of that entire project on a paper and explain each and every component. 3/4 of my projects were in **Go** (Rare to find such people). Then I was asked some system design based questions.

1. Your setup is in Andheri (Mumbai) and a person accessing from USA is observing latency, what will you do?
2. How will you handle millions of users?
3. How will you handle large file responses?

Then I was asked to differentiate between **SQL** and **NoSQL** databases (Now keep in mind NoSQL doesn't just mean MongoDB there are many other than that like Cassandra, Redis etc. so answer accordingly). Then he asked me which one is better: SQL or NoSQL? I had also mentioned horizontal scaling so I was also asked about that.

Then I was given a SQL query to solve which included JOIN + GROUP BY + HAVING + COUNT. My approach was using LEFT JOIN but interviewers approach was using INNER JOIN. Both worked. I had mistakenly switched the table names (**Do not panic, shrug it off like it never happened**).

I was asked about my most favorite (Operating Systems) and least favorite (FOSIP) subject. I was asked how many threads does a core have? Do they run in parallel? How did I manage to clear my least favorite subject?

A very very simple programming question was also asked. Then he asked me about the **internal working of HashMap, time complexity** of each type of working then about **sorting algorithms and their time complexity** and how do the ones having logarithmic time complexity work.

I was asked about **Hackathons** and the role of each member. I mentioned I had gone to some but didn't win any so he said **winning isn't important, the experience gained is much more important**.

I was then given the bridge puzzle [Link](#). My answer was higher so he told me to improve it. I wasn't able to do it (**Do not panic, shrug it off like it never happened**).

Then came some HR questions:

1. Strength and weakness?
2. How are you improving your weakness?
3. One mistake you never repeated?
4. What do you know about UBS?
5. Why do you want to work for UBS?
6. What is the latest news you have heard about UBS?
7. Family background?

Then he asked whether I had any questions for him. I asked:

1. First of all I asked his name since he didn't mention it.
2. How is your typical day at UBS?
3. What is your favorite part of the work at UBS?

It was such a long round that I don't even remember the time.

3. HR Round 1

This round was entirely based on behaviour. I answered it **loud and clearly** like an army personnel without flinching.

1. Tell me about your entire life journey from place of birth, 10th school and percentage, 12th college and percentage, CET score, how I landed in SPIT?
2. What was my first preference, **SPIT or VJTI**?
3. Favorite thing about SPIT?
4. Do you have any internship experience?
5. Have you been to hackathons?
6. What was the problem statement? (We had a long discussion on this)

Then he asked whether I had any questions for him. I asked:

1. What learning opportunities and certifications does UBS provide?
2. Are those certifications just relevant within UBS or even for outside companies?
3. How is the role switching process in UBS?

The round lasted about 10-15 minutes. I was so much in army mode that after the interview when the TPC asked me something I mistakenly said YES SRRR!! loudly.

4. HR Round 2

This round was just a background check and behavioural of about 5 minutes.

1. Why Computer Science Engineering?
2. Hackathon experience?
3. Open for relocation?
4. Are parents open for relocation?

Finally after a long wait 6 students (including me) were offered the role.

Useful Tips:

1. Nervous? Don't worry, just go and give the interview, everything will be fine after the first round. That day I realized my communication skills were much better than I expected them to be (Well they are worse for some personal reasons). **Your words should reflect wisdom.**
2. I didn't win any hackathons but had attended some and had experience. I was asked about hackathons in each round so try to go for as many as you can and try to work in a team. **Don't just make PPT but also develop something as a team.**
3. I didn't have any internship, I had projects but having an **internship would definitely help.**
4. I always tried to make **fun and useful projects.**

5. I used **Go** as my main language for development (**Try it if you have time it is way more fun than Javascript**).
6. The core subjects, the system design for your projects and follow-up questions are must.
7. Attending coding contests or virtual contests on Leetcode/Codeforces will help to solve problems under pressure.
8. Of course know your resume inside out. **DO NOT add anything that you don't know properly.**
9. If you don't know something don't tell them beforehand unless asked.
10. If your answer is NO just say it **loud and clear** as if you don't regret it just like an army personnel or just without any hesitation but humbly. Don't say it softly like you are scared.
11. I talked to a senior and my friends and fine tuned my resume accordingly.
12. Many candidates were multiple time hackathon winners and had internships but were still rejected, so always get your fundamentals right no matter what you have achieved.
13. One final thing is whenever you contact any senior, don't just ask about how they did it, also ask about what **mistakes** they made and **why they were rejected**. I wasn't able to clear PhonePe OA and then went on to clear UBS and MSCI OA's and was selected for UBS.

Resources I followed:

1. Data Structures & Algorithms: [Neetcode](#)
2. SQL: [Leetcode SQL 50](#) + [Datalemur](#)
3. Object Oriented Programming + Java: [Baeldung](#)
4. Operating Systems: [Operating Systems: Three Easy Pieces](#)
5. Database Management Systems: [Database Systems Concepts 7th Edition](#)
6. System Design: [GitHub - karanpratapsingh/system-design](#)
7. Aptitude: [IndiaBIX](#)

My Resume when I applied:  [UBS_Sahil_Patil.pdf](#)

Resume Template: [Jake's Resume \(Anonymous\) - Overleaf, Online LaTeX Editor](#)

Feel free to reach out for any questions [LinkedIn](#)

Remember **“A mistake is not a mistake unless you keep making it over and over again and if you never make a mistake you never learn anything !”**

All the best for Placements !!